THE BULLOCK PRESIDENCY

Series Bible — Document 02 (Revised): The Catastrophic Event — THE WAR (LOCKED CANON)

STATUS: LOCKED CANON. *The catastrophic event is a war: World War III, opened by The Blinding on Monday, September 13, 2032, in the final months of the second term. This supersedes the earlier "Unshielding" proposal.*

1. The Event: World War III, Opened by "The Blinding"

Day Zero name: The Blinding. **What the press calls it within the hour: World War III**. **Later historians' name:** the Global War of 2032. **Internet:** #TheBlinding, #WWIII, "Black Monday."

One-line pitch: the first war in history that starts in orbit and inside America's own wires, with no front line. In the first hour the United States loses its satellites, much of its power grid, and its ability to see the battlefield, while a coordinated coalition of nuclear-armed adversaries moves on several continents at once.

What happens on Day Zero

- **The sky goes dark.** Coordinated attacks on U.S. and allied satellites set off a **Kessler cascade**, a chain reaction of debris that shreds everything in low orbit. GPS, satellite communications, missile warning, and weather satellites start failing. Space may be unusable for a generation, for everyone, the enemy included. They gamble that the U.S. needs space more than they do.
- **The wires turn on America.** Malware hidden in U.S. infrastructure for years wakes up all at once and hits power grids, water systems, pipelines, ports, and rail. (Real-world grounding: "Volt Typhoon," a Chinese state-backed hacking group that U.S. officials said in 2023–24 had hidden itself inside American critical infrastructure.)
- **A war with no front line.** The homeland is hit first: drone and cyber strikes on military bases, logistics hubs, and command nodes inside the continental U.S. It is the first sustained attack by a foreign military on the U.S. mainland since the War of 1812.
- **Multiple theaters at once.** A move on Taiwan, pressure on NATO's eastern flank, a crisis on the Korean Peninsula, and a flare-up in the Middle East, all timed to overload American decision-making.
- **The information war.** In the first hour, a flawless deepfake of President Bullock announcing a ceasefire and surrender floods what's left of the internet. Americans can't tell what's real, and nor can allies.

2. Why It Is "Never Before Seen" and 1000x More Terrifying

- **It's the first orbital war.** No war has ever been fought in space. Once the debris cascade starts, nobody can stop it.
- **It moves at machine speed.** AI-driven cyber and drone systems act in milliseconds, faster than any human chain of command. Escalation could outrun the people who are supposed to control it.
- **Four nuclear-armed adversaries.** Every decision happens in the shadow of nuclear escalation. The enemy's doctrine is built to cripple America while staying just below the nuclear threshold, daring

Bullock to be the one who crosses it.

- **America is blind.** For the first time since WWII, the U.S. military fights without its eyes in the sky. Commanders fall back on paper maps, celestial navigation, and couriers.
- **The homeland is the battlefield.** Previous wars happened "over there." This one takes your power, water, phone, paycheck, and pharmacy on the first day.
- **Nobody can trust what they see.** Deepfakes, hacked emergency alerts, and fake government accounts. The President's own voice can be faked.
- **No country is a safe harbor.** Allies are hit at the same time. Nobody is coming to rescue anyone.

3. Timing: Still the Second Term, Final Months

Day Zero: Monday, September 13, 2032, 50 days before Election Day (Tuesday, November 2, 2032).

A war fits the second term even better than the previous idea, because it mirrors real history:

- **The FDR precedent.** Franklin Roosevelt won a third and fourth term during World War II on the idea of "don't change horses in midstream." The 22nd Amendment (ratified 1951) exists *because* of that. Our story's central irony is that war created the two-term limit, and war is what brings the fight to break it.
- **The enemy picks the date on purpose.** They aren't nerfed. Adversaries strike during America's most vulnerable moment: a lame-duck president, a divided election season, and a transition months away.
- **The opposition has a powerful counter-argument.** "Lincoln held an election in 1864, in the middle of the Civil War. FDR held elections in 1940 and 1944. America does not cancel democracy because of war." That argument is strong and stays alive throughout.

4. Proposed War Timeline

Date	Phase	What happens
2023–2024 (real)	Real-world seeds	Real background the story can use: Volt Typhoon disclosures, undersea cable incidents in the Baltic, Russian anti-satellite concerns, and the "Davidson Window" (Adm. Davidson's 2021 testimony that China could move on Taiwan by 2027).
2027 (Term 1)	The First Crisis	A Taiwan Strait crisis that Bullock defuses. It makes his reputation. The adversaries study his playbook, conclude they moved too soon, and start planning something far bigger.
2025–2031	Seeds	Small B-plots: a satellite that "malfunctions," a regional blackout blamed on a squirrel, an analyst whose warning is buried, an anti-satellite test, a strange purchase of container ships. Every one of them pays off.
Sat Jan 20, 2029	Term 2 begins	Second inauguration.
Mid-2032	Warnings	Intelligence chatter spikes. Bullock is term-limited, the 2032 campaigns are in full swing, and his warnings are dismissed as a lame duck trying to stay relevant.
Mon Sep 13, 2032	**THE BLINDING**	Day Zero, told minute by minute: the Situation Room, NORAD, Taiwan, a Midwest family losing power, a Pentagon officer reaching for a paper map, the deepfake, and Bullock's first words to a nation that can barely hear him.
Sep–Oct 2032	The Dark Weeks	Mobilization, rationing, partial restoration, emergency powers debates, allied coordination, espionage, and domestic unrest.

Date	Phase	What happens
Tue Nov 2, 2032	The Wartime Election	Cyberattacks on election systems and blackout zones in several states. Does America hold, delay, or redo the election?
Late 2032–Jan 2033	The Amendment Fight	Congress and the states race to suspend or repeal the 22nd Amendment for the duration of the war. Precedent for speed: the 26th Amendment was ratified in about 100 days in 1971.
Thu Jan 20, 2033, noon ET	The Deadline	The 20th Amendment's hard deadline for the end of his term.
2033 onward	The Long War	A third term as a wartime president. Victory, stalemate, or a negotiated peace is the author's choice, and the war's length determines whether a fourth term is in play (as with FDR).

5. The Adversary Coalition: New, Younger Leaders (LOCKED)

Locked rule: by Day Zero (Sep 13, 2032), every adversary nation is led by **new, younger leaders**. The old guard of 2023 is gone, and a hungrier, more tech-native generation runs the war. They grew up studying America, they know the internet as a weapon, and they have decades of rule ahead of them, which makes them willing to gamble.

The successions are story arcs

- Each handover happens on-screen, between 2023 and 2032, inside Bullock's timeline: a death, a palace coup, an engineered retirement, or a dynastic handoff. Each is serialized, and each changes the board.
- Bullock meets several of these leaders *before* the war: at summits, on calls, and in the 2027 Taiwan crisis. The personal history makes Day Zero hit harder.
- The old leaders' ages at the time they leave power are calculated from their real birthdays (Xi: June 15, 1953; Putin: Oct 7, 1952; Kim Jong Un: Jan 8, 1984, official).

Locked: a mix of real and fictional leaders. Real rising figures and author-created fictional characters share the stage. The split below is the recommended default, and the author can swap any row.

Nation	2023 leader	2032 leader	Type	Notes
China	Xi Jinping	Fictional (author creates)	FICTIONAL	No clear real heir exists. A leader born in the 1970s (aged 50s in 2032) who rises through the Party during Bullock's first term.
Russia	Vladimir Putin	Dmitry Patrushev	REAL	b. Oct 13, 1977; age 54 on Day Zero, turns 55 a month into the war. Son of Putin's longtime security chief, which gives him establishment legitimacy. Alternate: Aleksei Dyumin (b. Aug 28, 1972; age 60).
North Korea	Kim Jong Un	Kim Ju Ae	REAL	Kim's daughter, born around 2013 (exact date unconfirmed, so the author sets a canon birthday). About 19 on Day Zero: the world's youngest nuclear-armed head of state. Dangerous and underestimated.
Iran	Supreme Leader (2023)	Fictional (author creates)	FICTIONAL	A younger hardliner, possibly from the Revolutionary Guard, who comes to power during Bullock's presidency.

- Real figures are portrayed as fictionalized versions of themselves in an alternate timeline. From April 20, 2023 on, their actions are the story's invention.
- **Not nerfed:** every new leader is strategically brilliant, patient, and ruthless, has studied every American weakness, and has studied Bullock himself.

6. Path to More Than Two Terms (Options)

- **Option A, the Wartime Continuity Amendment (recommended):** an amendment suspending the 22nd Amendment for the duration of a congressionally declared war. Bullock wins a wartime election. It is realistic, democratic, and mirrors the FDR precedent, and opponents get a strong cause to fight under.
- **Option B, full repeal** of the 22nd Amendment.
- **Option C, the succession route:** the election collapses and a constitutional chain puts Bullock back in office. Darker, and it hands his enemies the line "dictator."
- A formal declaration of war (the first since June 1942) would itself be a historic, high-drama vote in Congress.

7. Sample Day Zero Headlines and Posts

> *@AP (7:52 AM EDT): BREAKING: Widespread GPS and satellite outages reported across U.S.; Pentagon "assessing"*
>
> *@random_user: my uber driver is using a paper map. a PAPER MAP*
>
> *CNN chyron (8:31 AM): ATTACK ON AMERICA — MULTIPLE U.S. BASES STRUCK — PRESIDENT EXPECTED TO ADDRESS NATION*
>
> *@random_user: is that video of bullock surrendering real??? someone tell me it isn't real*
>
> *WALL STREET JOURNAL (Sep 14, 2032): "WAR"*

8. Writing Guardrails

- Show strategy, decisions, and human cost, not technical how-to. The drama lives in the rooms where choices are made and in the homes where the consequences land.
- Real institutions (Joint Chiefs, NORAD, Space Force, CISA, NSA, FEMA, NATO) act at full competence. So does the enemy.
- Depict it at TV-MA intensity. Casualties are real, named where it matters, and carried forward in continuity.